

REASON, REVELATION AND FAITH

THREE-TERM CONTROL → FOUR RELATION MODELS → REVELATION TYPES AND TESTS → AQUINAS AND NATURAL THEOLOGY → KIERKEGAARD, FIDEISM AND FAITH → SCIENCE, MIRACLE AND TESTIMONY

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g9 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 THREE-TERM CONTROL

THREE-TERM CONTROL PUBLICLY ASSESSABLE INFERENCE, COHERENCE AND EVIDENCE CLAIMED DIVINE SELF-DISCLOSURE THROUGH EVENT, PERSON, TEXT OR EXPERIENCE TRUSTING COMMITMENT WITH COGNITIVE, VOLITIONAL AND PRACTICAL DIMENSIONS REASON

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- REASON: publicly assessable inference, coherence and evidence
- REVELATION: claimed divine self-disclosure through event, person, text or experience

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- FAITH: trusting commitment with cognitive, volitional and practical dimensions reason tests interpretation
- revelation supplies content faith appropriates a
- it is not merely low-evidence assent.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- REASON: publicly assessable inference, coherence and evidence
- REVELATION: claimed divine self-disclosure through event, person, text or experience

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Reason tests coherence and warrant, revelation claims divine self-disclosure, and faith receives that disclosure through trust and commitment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Reason tests coherence and warrant, revelation claims divine self-disclosure, and faith receives that disclosure through trust and commitment.

01

STAGE 01 FOUR RELATION MODELS

FOUR RELATION MODELS REASON AND FAITH ONE DEFEATS THE OTHER (STRONG RATIONALISM) DISTINCT DOMAINS OR LANGUAGE-GAMES MUTUAL QUESTIONS, ANALOGIES AND CORRECTION ONE COHERENT ACCOUNT; NATURAL AND REVEALED THEOLOGY COOPERATE EXAM RULE

IDENTIFY WHICH REASON, WHICH FAITH AND WHICH CLAIM

REASON AND FAITH

CONFLICT: one defeats the other (strong rationalism / fideism)

INDEPENDENCE: distinct domains or language-games

DIALOGUE: mutual questions, analogies and correction

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- REASON AND FAITH
- CONFLICT: one defeats the other (strong rationalism / fideism)
- INDEPENDENCE: distinct domains or language-games

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- DIALOGUE: mutual questions, analogies and correction
- INTEGRATION: one coherent account; natural and revealed theology cooperate
- EXAM RULE: identify which reason, which faith and which claim

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- scientific mechanism, metaphysical ground and salvific meaning need not compete directly.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — EXAM RULE: identify which reason, which faith and which claim;

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: identify which reason, which faith and which claim;

02

STAGE 02 REVELATION TYPES AND TESTS

REVELATION TYPES AND TESTS CREATION, CONSCIENCE, UNIVERSAL REASON HISTORICAL ACT, PROPHET, INCARNATION, SCRIPTURE TRUTHS COMMUNICATED GOD DISCLOSED IN ENCOUNTER/HISTORY AUTHENTICATION TESTS INTERNAL COHERENCE MORAL FRUITS HISTORICAL CREDIBILITY

GENERAL / NATURAL: creation, conscience, universal reason

SPECIAL: historical act, prophet, incarnation, scripture

PROPOSITIONAL: truths communicated

PERSONAL/EVENT: God disclosed in encounter/history

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- GENERAL / NATURAL: creation, conscience, universal reason
- SPECIAL: historical act, prophet, incarnation, scripture
- PROPOSITIONAL: truths communicated

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- PERSONAL/EVENT: God disclosed in encounter/history
- AUTHENTICATION TESTS internal coherence
- moral fruits

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- historical credibility
- communal continuity fit with prior knowledge
- capacity to disclose rather than merely confirm desire circularity problem: scripture authenticates God while God authenticates scripture.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Indian epistemology reframes reason and revelation through pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), especially śabda (verbal testimony).

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Indian epistemology reframes reason and revelation through pramāṇa (means of valid knowledge), especially śabda (verbal testimony).

03

STAGE 03 AQUINAS AND NATURAL THEOLOGY

AQUINAS AND NATURAL THEOLOGY ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES TRUTHS ACCESSIBLE TO REASON THAT GOD EXISTS, SOME ATTRIBUTES, NATURAL LAW MYSTERIES ABOVE TRINITY, INCARNATION; NOT CONTRARY TO REASON GRACE PERFECTS NATURE IMPORTED METAPHYSICS MAY DOMESTICATE REVELATION REPLY

REASON DOES NOT GENERATE MYSTERY; IT REMOVES CONTRADICTION AND

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES truths accessible to reason: that God exists, some attributes, natural law mysteries above reason; Trinity, Incarnation
- not contrary to reason grace perfects nature

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- revelation guides reason where inquiry is difficult or salvation urgent contradiction cannot be genuinely divine because truth cannot
- it removes contradiction and clarifies implication.

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES truths accessible to reason: that God exists, some attributes, natural law mysteries above reason; Trinity, Incarnation
- not contrary to reason grace perfects nature

MECHANISM / VERDICT — ONE TRUTH, TWO ROUTES truths accessible to reason: that God exists, some attributes, natural law mysteries above reason; Trinity, Incarnation; not contrary to reason grace perfects nature; revelation guides reason where inquiry is difficult or salvation urgent contradiction cannot be genuinely divine because truth cannot conflict with truth objection: imported metaphysics may domesticate revelation reply: reason does not generate mystery; it removes contradiction and clarifies implication.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Revelation is an alleged divine self-disclosure that supplies truth or presence unavailable to unaided reason.

04

STAGE 04 KIERKEGAARD, FIDEISM AND FAITH

KIERKEGAARD, FIDEISM AND FAITH OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY + INFINITE PERSONAL CONCERN SUBJECTIVE APPROPRIATION FAITH IS PASSIONATE COMMITMENT, NOT A THEOREM FORCED BY ABRAHAM EXPOSES THE "TELEOLOGICAL SUSPENSION OF THE ETHICAL" PROBLEM PROPOSITIONAL ASSENT

TRUST AND ALLEGIANCE FAITH MAY EXCEED AVAILABLE PROOF WITHOUT LEAP LICENSES FANATICISM

OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY + INFINITE PERSONAL CONCERN – SUBJECTIVE APPROPRIATION

Kierkegaard: faith is passionate commitment, not a theorem forced by detached proof

Abraham exposes the "teleological suspension of the ethical" problem belief-that: propositional assent

belief-in: trust and allegiance faith may exceed available proof without affirming contradiction objection: leap licenses

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY + INFINITE PERSONAL CONCERN – SUBJECTIVE APPROPRIATION
- Kierkegaard: faith is passionate commitment, not a theorem forced by detached proof

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Abraham exposes the "teleological suspension of the ethical" problem belief-that: propositional assent
- belief-in: trust and allegiance faith may exceed available proof without affirming contradiction objection: leap licenses fanaticism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- reply: authentic faith entails inward risk, responsibility and transformation, not arbitrary immunity from criticism.
- OBJECTIVE UNCERTAINTY + INFINITE PERSONAL CONCERN – SUBJECTIVE APPROPRIATION

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: Faith is firm trust and commitment that goes beyond conclusive proof without necessarily opposing reason.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Faith is firm trust and commitment that goes beyond conclusive proof without necessarily opposing reason.

05

STAGE 05 SCIENCE, MIRACLE AND TESTIMONY

SCIENCE, MIRACLE AND TESTIMONY SCIENCE ASKS REPEATABLE NATURAL MECHANISM; RELIGION MAY ASK GROUND HUME ON MIRACLES PROPORTION BELIEF TO EVIDENCE; FALSE TESTIMONY IS USUALLY MORE ASSESS SPECIFIC EVENT, INDEPENDENT WITNESSES, BACKGROUND PROBABILITY AND DIVINE TESTIMONY IS INDISPENSABLE BUT DEFEASIBLE; MIRACLE CANNOT BE INFERRED

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

HUME ON MIRACLES: proportion belief to evidence; false testimony is usually more probable than violation of uniform experience

EVALUATION / TRAP

TESTIMONY is indispensable but defeasible; miracle cannot be inferred merely from anomaly.

religion may ask ground, value and destiny conflict arises when sacred interpretation makes empirical claims or scientism makes total claims

REPLIES: assess specific event, independent witnesses, background probability and divine context

SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism
- religion may ask ground, value and destiny conflict arises when sacred interpretation makes empirical claims or scientism makes total claims

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- HUME ON MIRACLES: proportion belief to evidence; false testimony is usually more probable than violation of uniform experience
- REPLIES: assess specific event, independent witnesses, background probability and divine context

EVALUATION / TRAP

- TESTIMONY is indispensable but defeasible; miracle cannot be inferred merely from anomaly.
- SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism

MECHANISM / VERDICT — SCIENCE asks repeatable natural mechanism; religion may ask ground, value and destiny conflict arises when sacred interpretation makes empirical claims or scientism makes total claims

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Science explains empirically testable processes, while religion addresses ultimate meaning, value and, at times, claims that intersect with evidence.

06

STAGE 06 JUSTIFICATION AND INDIAN PARITY

JUSTIFICATION AND INDIAN PARITY BELIEF SHOULD MATCH PUBLICLY AVAILABLE EVIDENCE REFORMED EPISTEMOLOGY BELIEF IN GOD MAY BE PROPERLY BASIC UNLESS DEFEATED WITTGENSTEINIAN VIEW FAITH HAS GRAMMAR WITHIN A FORM OF LIFE INDIAN PARITY ŚRUTI/ŚABDA AS TESTIMONY

YUKTI AS REASONING

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- EVIDENTIALISM: belief should match publicly available evidence
- REFORMED EPISTEMOLOGY: belief in God may be properly basic unless defeated
- WITTGENSTEINIAN VIEW: faith has grammar within a form of life
- INDIAN PARITY śruti/śabda as testimony

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- yukti as reasoning
- anubhava as realisation
- Advaita: scripture initiates inquiry; reasoning removes contradiction
- knowledge culminates in direct realisation

EVALUATION / TRAP

- Nyāya: āpta testimony is a pramāṇa but must be semantically and causally trustworthy
- Mīmāṃsā: authorless Veda avoids dependence on a divine speaker.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- EVIDENTIALISM: belief should match publicly available evidence
- REFORMED EPISTEMOLOGY: belief in God may be properly basic unless defeated
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DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- yukti as reasoning
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EVALUATION / TRAP

- Nyāya: āpta testimony is a pramāṇa but must be semantically and causally trustworthy
- Mīmāṃsā: authorless Veda avoids dependence on a divine speaker.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Recommended opening definition: The justification debate asks whether religious belief requires inferential evidence or may be properly basic yet defeasible.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: The justification debate asks whether religious belief requires inferential evidence or may be properly basic yet defeasible.

07

STAGE 07 PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS

PYQ ANSWER SYNTHESIS DEFINE ALL THREE TERMS SELECT CONFLICT/INDEPENDENCE/DIALOGUE/INTEGRATION MODEL DISTINGUISH REVELATION TYPE NAMED THINKER STRONGEST OBJECTION AND REPLY INDIAN ŚRUTI-YUKTI-ANUBHAVA COMPARISON

PRACTICAL AND PUBLIC IMPLICATIONS AVOID "FAITH VERSUS REASON" AS

DEFINE all three terms – select conflict/independence/dialogue/integration model

distinguish revelation type – named thinker – strongest objection and reply

Indian śruti-yukti-anubhava comparison – practical and public implications avoid "faith versus reason" as a slogan

is contrary, above or supported by reason

QUALIFIED VERDICT: faith needs neither reduction to proof nor exemption from criticism

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE all three terms – select conflict/independence/dialogue/integration model
- distinguish revelation type – named thinker – strongest objection and reply

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Indian śruti-yukti-anubhava comparison – practical and public implications avoid "faith versus reason" as a slogan: ask whether faith
- is contrary, above or supported by reason

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- QUALIFIED VERDICT: faith needs neither reduction to proof nor exemption from criticism
- rationally responsible faith is interpretive trust answerable to coherence, evidence and moral fruit.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFIED VERDICT: faith needs neither reduction to proof nor exemption from criticism;

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: faith needs neither reduction to proof nor exemption from criticism;

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT ADVANCED-DOSSIER RECONCILIATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] DOCTRINE STATEMENT. REASON CAN INFER AND TEST SOME RELIGIOUS IT IDENTIFIES PUBLICLY ACCESSIBLE PREMISES, DERIVES IMPLICATIONS, TESTS COHERENCE PRESUPPOSITION. CAUTION

REALITY IS INTELLIGIBLE AND REASON IS NOT WHOLLY CORRUPTED NATURAL THEOLOGY DIFFERS FROM PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION THE FORMER ARGUES TOWARD THEOLOGICAL CONCLUSIONS

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Advanced-dossier reconciliation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Doctrine statement. Reason can infer and test some religious claims without relying on a special historical disclosure.
- Argument.
- It identifies publicly accessible premises, derives implications, tests coherence, and distinguishes demonstration, probability and practical postulation.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- Presupposition. CAUTION: Reality is intelligible and reason is not wholly corrupted or confined to empirical objects.
- Distinction.
- Natural theology differs from philosophy of religion: the former argues toward theological conclusions
- the latter also analyses language, experience and warrant.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Canonical examples. Aquinas' preambles of faith; Nyāya inference to Īśvara.
- Objection → reply.
- CAUTION: Kant restricts speculative reason beyond possible experience.
- Natural theologians reply that metaphysical inference concerns conditions of experience, not another observed object.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.